

U.S. HISTORY HACK

Unit 10

The Modern Era

The Great Society · Vietnam-Era Activism · Watergate · The Reagan Era & the End of the Cold War · 9/11 · The Digital Revolution · 1964–2016

Standards US.83 – US.95

US.83

US.84

US.85

US.86

US.87

US.88

US.89

US.90

US.91

US.92

US.93

US.94

US.95

UNIT ROADMAP

Where We Are Headed

Unit 10 • The Modern Era (1964–2016) — from Johnson's Great Society, the social activism and counterculture of the 1960s, and Nixon and Watergate, through environmentalism, the Reagan era and the end of the Cold War, to Clinton and the 1990s, September 11th, the digital revolution, and the Obama years



BELL RINGER · HOOK

In 1964, President Johnson promised to build a "Great Society" that would end poverty and racial injustice. Over the next half century, the nation moved through the turmoil of Vietnam and Watergate, the end of the Cold War, the shock of September 11th, a digital revolution, and the election of its first Black president.

How did the United States move from the confidence of the Great Society in 1964 to the challenges and transformations of the twenty-first century — and what forces reshaped American life along the way?

TURN & TALK

With a partner, list three ways American life today — how people communicate, who holds power, and the role of government — is different from the way it was in 1964. Then predict which event in this unit did the most to create each change. Keep your list; we will return to it at the end of the unit.

STANDARD

US.83

Johnson's Great Society Programs

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Evaluate the impact of President Lyndon Johnson's Great Society programs, including: Medicare, urban renewal, and the War on Poverty.

I CAN

I can evaluate the impact of President Lyndon Johnson's Great Society programs, including Medicare, urban renewal, and the War on Poverty.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

Unit 9 We just finished Unit 9 on the Civil Rights Movement. What did major laws like the Civil Rights Act of 1964 and the Voting Rights Act of 1965 accomplish?

2

Unit Hook Look back at our unit hook. What big question about the modern era are we going to keep returning to?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What was President Johnson's name for his set of anti-poverty and social programs?

✓ **ANSWER**

The Great Society.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In just a few years, President Lyndon Johnson pushed Congress to create Medicare, Medicaid, Head Start, and a “War on Poverty” — the largest expansion of government help since the New Deal, all under one banner: the Great Society.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Should the federal government be responsible for fighting poverty and providing health care — or should that be left to states, charities, and families? What did the Great Society decide?

Great Society Programs Overview

- President Johnson's Great Society (1964-1969) created an ambitious domestic agenda aimed at eliminating poverty and racial injustice.
- Key programs included: Medicare (health insurance for Americans over 65), Medicaid (health coverage for low-income families), Head Start (early childhood education for disadvantaged children), VISTA (Volunteers in Service to America — domestic Peace Corps), the Elementary and Secondary Education Act (federal funding for schools), Urban Renewal (federal programs to rebuild inner cities), and the War on Poverty (a comprehensive anti-poverty initiative).

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The Great Society created ___ in order to ___, which expanded the federal government's role in ___.

Medicare's Effect on Healthcare

- Medicare dramatically improved healthcare access for elderly Americans, who previously faced insurance discrimination due to age and pre-existing conditions.
- It reduced medical bankruptcies among seniors and established the principle of government-guaranteed healthcare.
- However, costs escalated beyond projections, creating long-term fiscal challenges and debates about healthcare spending that continue today.



White House Press Office, 1965 [LBJ Presidential Library \(Austin\)](#)

Urban Renewal Consequences

- Urban renewal projects often displaced low-income, predominantly minority communities to build highways, shopping centers, and middle-class housing.
- While intended to eliminate "slums," these programs frequently destroyed established neighborhoods, disrupted social networks, and contributed to racial segregation by concentrating displaced residents in public housing projects.

War on Poverty Effectiveness

- The poverty rate fell from 22.4% in 1959 to 12.6% in 1970, suggesting initial success.
- Programs like Head Start and food stamps provided crucial support.
- However, poverty rates plateaued in the 1970s, and critics argued that welfare dependency increased.
- The initiative's mixed results sparked ongoing debates about government's role in addressing inequality.

Key Figure

President Lyndon B. Johnson

36th President of the United States

- Launched the Great Society and the War on Poverty (1964)
- Signed Medicare and Medicaid into law (1965)

STRATEGY Legislative reform (federal social programs)

Great Society Speech

President Lyndon B. Johnson • May 22, 1964

Close Reading

"The Great Society rests on abundance and liberty for all. It demands an end to poverty and racial injustice, to which we are totally committed in our time. But that is just the beginning. The Great Society is a place where every child can find knowledge to enrich his mind and to enlarge his talents."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

In May 1964, President Johnson used a commencement address at the University of Michigan to unveil his vision of a "Great Society." Coming just months after taking office following Kennedy's assassination, Johnson laid out an ambitious agenda to use federal power to end poverty and racial injustice and to expand education and opportunity for all Americans.

ANALYZE

What were the goals of Johnson's Great Society?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? President Lyndon B. Johnson	WHEN? May 22, 1964	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose and audience before you interpret the words.
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Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Great Society

Gran Sociedad

say: grayt soh-SY-eh-tee

GS

President Lyndon B. Johnson's 1960s domestic program to end poverty and racial injustice and expand education, health care, and civil rights.

War on Poverty

Guerra contra la Pobreza

say: wor on POV-er-tee

WO

LBJ's set of Great Society programs — including Head Start and Job Corps — created in 1964 to reduce poverty in the United States.

Medicare and Medicaid

Medicare y Medicaid

say: MED-ih-kair and MED-ih-kaid

MA

Federal health-insurance programs created in 1965: Medicare for Americans 65 and older, Medicaid for low-income families.

Head Start

Head Start (Programa Preescolar)

say: hed START

HS

A 1965 Great Society program providing early childhood education, health, and nutrition services to low-income children.

Urban Renewal

Renovación Urbana

say: UR-bin ree-NOO-ul

UR

Federal programs that cleared and rebuilt city neighborhoods; often displaced poor and minority residents despite new housing and highways.

Voting Rights Act of 1965

Ley de Derecho al Voto de 1965

say: VOH-ting ryts akt

VR

A Great Society law that banned literacy tests and other barriers used to deny African Americans the right to vote.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Evaluate the impact of a government program

MODEL PROMPT: Read Johnson's Great Society speech. What outcome does he promise, and how would we measure whether it worked?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Johnson promises "an end to poverty and racial injustice" and opportunity for "every child."

THINK ALOUD

To evaluate impact, I would look for evidence — like the poverty rate falling from 22.4% to 12.6% — and also for unintended consequences, like urban renewal displacing communities.

→ **Now you try:** Now you: name one Great Society program and one measurable result (positive or negative) that lets us judge its impact.

The Great Society — Causes & Consequences Chart

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes and Johnson's "Great Society" speech excerpt, complete the Causes & Consequences organizer. In the CAUSES column, list the conditions Johnson wanted to fix (poverty, lack of health care for the elderly, unequal education). In the CONSEQUENCES column, trace the programs that followed — Medicare, Medicaid, the War on Poverty, Head Start, and federal education aid — and what each one did. Finish with a one-sentence claim about whether the Great Society succeeded in building Johnson's vision.

DELIVERABLE

Completed Causes & Consequences organizer (3+ causes, 3+ consequences) plus a one-sentence evidence-based claim on the Great Society's lasting impact.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer pre-seeded with a word bank (Medicare, Medicaid, War on Poverty, Head Start, Great Society) to sort into Causes vs. Consequences. Honors: Evaluate the long-term significance of the Great Society — which program most changed American life, and does it still matter today? Defend with evidence.

Companion printable: [printables/unit-10/unit-10-cause-effect.html](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/printables/unit-10/unit-10-cause-effect.html)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

How did Johnson describe his approach to fighting poverty?

- A** Simply expanding existing charity programs
- B** Leaving poverty reduction to state governments
- C** A new approach that strikes at the causes of poverty, not just consequences
- D** Reducing government involvement in social programs

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did Johnson describe his approach to fighting poverty?

- A** Simply expanding existing charity programs
- B** Leaving poverty reduction to state governments
- C** A new approach that strikes at the causes of poverty, not just consequences ✓
- D** Reducing government involvement in social programs

Correct answer: C. **Why:** Johnson emphasizes that the Act "charts a new course" and "strikes at the causes, not just the consequences of poverty," distinguishing it from previous programs.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Great Society Programs Overview
- Medicare's Effect on Healthcare
- Urban Renewal Consequences
- War on Poverty Effectiveness

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate the long-term significance of the Great Society. Which program most changed American life, and does it still matter today? Defend your answer with evidence.

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain what the Great Society was and describe two programs it created. Why is it considered a major expansion of the federal government?

STANDARD

US.84

Social Activism and Counterculture

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Analyze different points of view that reflect the rise of social activism and the growth of counterculture, including generation gap, hippies, and Woodstock.

I CAN

I can analyze different points of view that reflect the rise of social activism and the growth of counterculture, including the generation gap, hippies, and Woodstock.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.83 In the last standard we studied Johnson's Great Society. Name two programs it created and what they did.

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What war did most 1960s youth protests oppose?

✓ **ANSWER**

The Vietnam War.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

While their parents celebrated 1950s prosperity, millions of young Americans in the 1960s marched against the Vietnam War, questioned authority, and built a “counterculture” — opening a “generation gap” that split families and the nation.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

When a whole generation rejects the values of the one before it, is that a sign of a society breaking down — or of a society changing and growing?

Different Viewpoints on Social Activism

- Supporters saw activism as necessary democratic participation addressing social injustices like civil rights, poverty, and unjust wars.
- Critics viewed protesters as unpatriotic radicals undermining American institutions, values, and military morale.
- This divide reflected fundamental disagreements about patriotism, authority, and social change.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

In the 1960s, young Americans in the counterculture protested ___ by ___, which caused older Americans to ___.



SP5 Robert C. Lafoon, Department of the Army Special Photo Office (DASPO), 1967
[National Archives and Records Administration \(NARA\)](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

The Generation Gap

- The gap reflected fundamental differences between older Americans who experienced the Depression and World War II and younger Americans questioning authority, traditional values, and foreign policy.
- Younger Americans who had grown up in postwar prosperity felt freer to challenge the establishment their parents had built and defended.

The Hippie Movement

- Hippies rejected materialism, embraced peace and love, experimented with drugs, and created alternative communities.
- They opposed the Vietnam War and promoted environmental awareness, influencing music, fashion, and social attitudes.
- Their lifestyle challenged middle-class conformity and sparked both admiration and outrage.



Johnson White House Photo Office, October 21, 1967
[National Archives and Records Administration \(NARA\)](#)

Woodstock's Significance

- The 1969 music festival symbolized counterculture values of peace, music, and community.
- Despite logistical problems — rain, inadequate facilities, massive crowds — it demonstrated young Americans' desire for alternative social arrangements.
- Woodstock became an iconic moment of 1960s idealism, even as the decade's optimism soon gave way to disillusionment.

Key Figure

Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.

Civil rights leader and anti-war voice

- Publicly opposed the Vietnam War in his 1967 "Beyond Vietnam" speech
- Linked the struggle against poverty at home to the cost of war abroad

STRATEGY Moral persuasion (nonviolent protest)

Gulf of Tonkin Resolution

Close Reading

U.S. Congress • August 7, 1964

"The Congress approves and supports the determination of the President, as Commander in Chief, to take all necessary measures to repel any armed attack against the forces of the United States and to prevent further aggression... The United States is, therefore, prepared, as the President determines, to take all necessary steps, including the use of armed force."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

After reported attacks on U.S. Navy ships in the Gulf of Tonkin, Congress passed this resolution in August 1964. It gave President Johnson broad authority to expand American military involvement in Vietnam without a formal declaration of war — fueling the anti-war activism that helped define the counterculture era.

ANALYZE

What power did the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution grant to the President?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? U.S. Congress	WHEN? August 7, 1964	WHY does it matter? Consider who wrote this and why before you decide what power it really granted.
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Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Counterculture

say: KOWN-ter-kul-cher

Contracultura

CO

A 1960s youth movement that rejected mainstream values, embracing new music, dress, and views on peace, freedom, and social change.

Hippie Movement

say: HIP-ee MOOV-ment

Movimiento Hippie

HM

A counterculture group of the 1960s that promoted peace, love, communal living, and opposition to the Vietnam War.

Antiwar Movement

say: AN-tee-wor MOOV-ment

Movimiento contra la Guerra

AM

Widespread 1960s-70s protests, especially on college campuses, against U.S. involvement in the Vietnam War.

Generation Gap

say: jen-er-AY-shun gap

Brecha Generacional

GG

The sharp differences in values, politics, and culture between 1960s youth and their parents' generation.

Woodstock

say: WOOD-stok

Woodstock

WO

A 1969 music festival in New York that drew 400,000 people and became a symbol of the counterculture and antiwar spirit.

New Left

say: noo LEFT

Nueva Izquierda

NL

A 1960s political movement of young activists who pushed for civil rights, free speech, and an end to the Vietnam War.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Analyze competing points of view

MODEL PROMPT: Two Americans watch the same anti-war march in 1967. One sees patriots; one sees traitors. How do I analyze both views fairly?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Supporters framed protest as democratic participation; critics framed it as undermining the country and the troops.

THINK ALOUD

To analyze a point of view, I ask what experiences and values shape it — Depression-and-WWII elders valued authority and sacrifice, while postwar youth felt free to question it.

→ **Now you try:** Now you: pick one counterculture symbol (hippies, Woodstock, or protest) and explain how a supporter and a critic would each describe it.

Protest & Counterculture — SAPA Chart

Groups of 3

18 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes, complete the SAPA chart (Situation — Action — Problem — Action) for THREE forms of 1960s activism: the anti-war movement, the student movement, and the counterculture. For each, identify the Situation (what they opposed), the Action taken (the tactic — marches, teach-ins, sit-ins), the Problem/backlash it met, and the further Action or outcome. Note how the “silent majority” reacted to these movements.

DELIVERABLE

Completed SAPA chart for three movements, each with all four columns filled, plus one sentence on which movement had the biggest effect on public opinion about Vietnam.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: SAPA chart with one movement pre-filled as a model and a word bank of tactics (teach-in, march, draft-card burning, sit-in). Honors: Analyze how the counterculture and anti-war movements reshaped American culture and politics — what did they change permanently, and what backlash did they trigger?

Companion printable: [printables/unit-10/unit-10-sapa.html](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/printables/unit-10/unit-10-sapa.html)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

What conclusion did Walter Cronkite reach about the Vietnam War?

- A** America was winning and should continue fighting
- B** America was losing and should surrender immediately
- C** The war was a stalemate and the only way out was negotiation
- D** The war would be over within weeks

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What conclusion did Walter Cronkite reach about the Vietnam War?

- A** America was winning and should continue fighting
- B** America was losing and should surrender immediately
- C** The war was a stalemate and the only way out was negotiation ✓
- D** The war would be over within weeks

Correct answer: C. **Why:** Cronkite concluded the war was "mired in stalemate" and that "the only rational way out then will be to negotiate" — a turning point in public opinion.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Different Viewpoints on Social Activism
- The Generation Gap
- The Hippie Movement
- Woodstock's Significance

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Analyze how the counterculture and anti-war movements changed American society. What did they change permanently, and what backlash did they trigger? Argue with evidence.

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Describe the counterculture and the “generation gap” of the 1960s. What did young Americans protest, and how did older Americans react?

STANDARD

US.85

Nixon Administration Achievements

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Explain significant achievements of President Richard Nixon's administration, including his appeal to the "silent majority" and his major foreign policy actions.

I CAN

I can explain significant achievements of President Richard Nixon's administration, including his appeal to the "silent majority" and his major foreign policy actions.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.84 We just studied 1960s social activism and the counterculture. What was the “generation gap,” and what did young protesters oppose?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Which communist country did Nixon famously visit in 1972?

✓ **ANSWER**

China.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

The same president who was forced to resign in disgrace also opened relations with communist China, eased tensions with the Soviet Union, and won a landslide by appealing to what he called the “silent majority.”

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Nixon appealed to the “silent majority” — Americans who did not protest but felt unheard. Why can the people who stay quiet sometimes matter more in an election than the ones in the streets?

Significant Achievements

- Nixon's achievements spanned multiple areas.
- In foreign policy, he pursued détente with the Soviet Union, opened relations with China, and signed the SALT I Treaty.
- In domestic policy, he created the Environmental Protection Agency, saw Title IX passed for gender equality in education, and enforced desegregation.
- In economic policy, he imposed temporary wage and price controls and ended the gold standard.
- In social policy, the 26th Amendment lowered the voting age to 18.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

President Nixon appealed to the “silent majority” by ___, and in foreign policy he ___ in order to ___.

The "Silent Majority" Concept

- Nixon appealed to Americans who didn't participate in protests but supported traditional values and law and order.
- This strategy targeted middle-class voters frustrated with civil rights demonstrations, antiwar protests, and counterculture movements.
- It helped Nixon win working-class Democratic voters and reshape Republican electoral strategy for decades, creating a coalition that would dominate American politics.

Major Foreign Policy Initiatives

- China Opening: Secret diplomacy led to Nixon's historic 1972 China visit, establishing diplomatic relations and strategically isolating the Soviet Union.
- Détente: Reduced tensions with the USSR through arms control negotiations and increased trade.
- Vietnam: The Vietnamization policy gradually withdrew American troops while maintaining support for South Vietnam, though the country ultimately fell in 1975.

Key Figure

President Richard Nixon

37th President of the United States

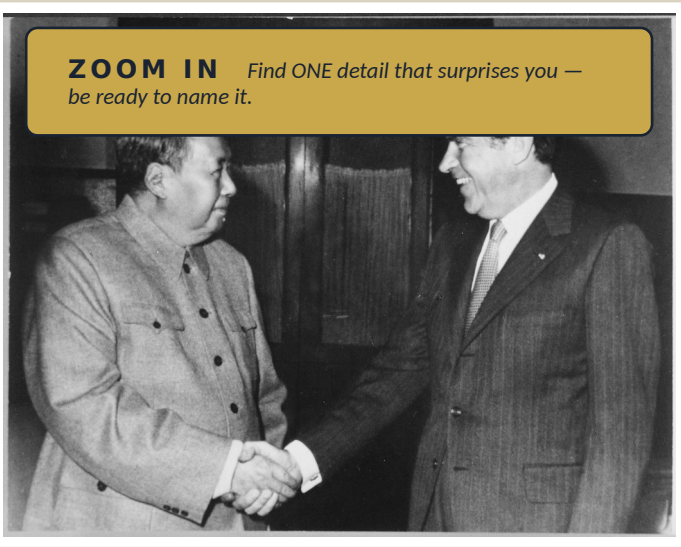
- Opened diplomatic relations with China with his historic 1972 visit
- Pursued détente and signed the SALT I arms-control treaty with the USSR

STRATEGY Diplomacy (Cold War realpolitik)

Silent Majority Speech

Argumentation

President Richard Nixon • November 3, 1969



Nixon White House Photographic Office, February 21, 1972
[National Archives and Records Administration \(NARA 194759\): via Wikimedia Commons](#)

"And so tonight — to you, the great silent majority of my fellow Americans — I ask for your support. I pledged in my campaign for the Presidency to end the war in a way that we could win the peace. I have initiated a plan of action which will enable me to keep that pledge."

CONTEXT

In November 1969, with anti-war protests growing, Nixon addressed the nation to defend his Vietnam policy. Rather than speak to the protesters, he appealed to what he called the "great silent majority" — ordinary Americans who did not march but, he claimed, quietly supported him.

ANALYZE

Who was Nixon appealing to in this speech?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	President Richard Nixon	November 3, 1969	Consider who Nixon is addressing and why before you judge the speech.

Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Silent Majority

say: SY-lent muh-JOR-ih-tee

Mayoría Silenciosa

SM

President Nixon's term for the many Americans who quietly supported his policies but did not join loud public protests.

Nixon Visits China

say: NIK-sun VIZ-its CHY-nuh

Visita de Nixon a China

NV

Nixon's historic 1972 trip that reopened U.S. relations with Communist China after more than 20 years of hostility.

Revenue Sharing

say: REV-en-yoo SHAIR-ing

Distribución de Ingresos Federales

RS

A Nixon program returning federal tax money to state and local governments to spend on their own priorities.

Détente

say: day-TAHNT

Distensión

DT

Nixon's policy of easing Cold War tensions with the Soviet Union and China through diplomacy and treaties.

SALT I

say: salt WUN

SALT I (Tratado de Armas)

SI

The 1972 Strategic Arms Limitation Talks treaty that limited U.S. and Soviet nuclear missiles, a key result of détente.

Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)

say: en-vy-run-MEN-tul pro-TEK-shun

Agencia de Protección Ambiental

EP

A federal agency created under Nixon in 1970 to write and enforce laws protecting air, water, and land.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Explain a leader's political strategy

MODEL PROMPT: Nixon says he speaks for a "silent majority." How do I explain what that strategy was and why it worked?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Nixon appealed to Americans who did not protest but valued law, order, and tradition.

THINK ALOUD

To explain a strategy, I identify the audience Nixon targeted (frustrated middle-class voters) and the goal (winning support without answering the protesters directly).

→ **Now you try:** *Now you: explain in one sentence how the "silent majority" appeal helped Nixon build a lasting political coalition.*

Nixon's Foreign Policy — Cause & Effect Chart

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes and Nixon's Silent Majority speech excerpt, complete the Cause & Effect organizer for Nixon's major foreign-policy moves. In CAUSES, list the Cold War problems Nixon faced (the Vietnam War, tension with the USSR, an isolated China). In EFFECTS, trace his responses — the 1972 opening to China, détente and SALT I with the Soviets, and Vietnamization. Finish with a claim about how Nixon used one communist power against another.

DELIVERABLE

Completed Cause & Effect organizer (3+ causes, 3+ effects) plus a one-sentence claim on how Nixon's China opening changed the balance of the Cold War.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer with a word bank (détente, SALT I, China visit, Vietnamization, silent majority) to place. Honors: Evaluate whether Nixon's foreign policy achievements outweigh the damage of Watergate. Argue with evidence.

Companion printable: [printables/unit-10/unit-10-cause-effect.html](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/printables/unit-10/unit-10-cause-effect.html)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

Who was Nixon appealing to in this speech?

- A Anti-war protestors
- B Military leaders only
- C Ordinary Americans who quietly supported his Vietnam policies
- D Foreign governments

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

Who was Nixon appealing to in this speech?

- A Anti-war protestors
- B Military leaders only
- C Ordinary Americans who quietly supported his Vietnam policies ✓**
- D Foreign governments

Correct answer: C. Why: Nixon directly addresses "the great silent majority of my fellow Americans," seeking support from those who did not join vocal protests but supported his approach.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Significant Achievements
- The "Silent Majority" Concept
- Major Foreign Policy Initiatives

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate whether Nixon's foreign-policy achievements outweigh the damage of Watergate to his legacy. Defend your position with evidence.

EXIT TICKET

DOK 3

Explain who Nixon meant by the “silent majority,” and describe his two major foreign-policy achievements.

STANDARD

US.86

Watergate Scandal

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Examine the Watergate scandal, including: Background of the break-in, Changing role of media and journalism, Controversy surrounding President Gerald Ford's pardon, Legacy of distrust, United States v. Nixon.

I CAN

I can examine the Watergate scandal, including the background of the break-in, the changing role of media, President Ford's pardon controversy, the legacy of distrust, and United States v. Nixon.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.85 In the last standard we studied Nixon's achievements. What were his two biggest foreign-policy moves?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What scandal forced President Nixon to resign in 1974?

✓ **ANSWER**

The Watergate scandal.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

A break-in at an office building led, step by step, to the only resignation of a U.S. president in history — and proved that in America, not even the president is above the law.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

When a president breaks the law, who is powerful enough to hold him accountable — the courts, Congress, the press, or the voters? Watergate tested all four.

The Break-in Circumstances

- On June 17, 1972, five men were arrested breaking into Democratic National Committee headquarters at the Watergate complex.
- Initial investigations revealed connections to Nixon's reelection campaign (CREEP) and White House officials, suggesting political espionage rather than a simple burglary.
- The cover-up that followed would prove more damaging than the original crime.

SENTENCE FRAME *(EL & writing support)*

The Watergate scandal began when ___, and it ended Nixon's presidency because ___.

Media's Changing Role

- Washington Post reporters Bob Woodward and Carl Bernstein conducted persistent investigative journalism, following money trails and cultivating sources (including "Deep Throat," later revealed as FBI Deputy Director Mark Felt).
- Television coverage brought congressional hearings into American homes, demonstrating the media's power to hold government accountable and establishing investigative journalism as a crucial democratic institution.

United States v. Nixon

- The Supreme Court unanimously ruled that executive privilege couldn't override judicial subpoenas for criminal proceedings.
- Nixon had to surrender White House tapes to prosecutors.
- This landmark decision established limits on presidential power and affirmed that no one, including the president, is above the law — a fundamental principle of American constitutional government.

Ford's Pardon and Legacy of Distrust

- President Ford's unconditional pardon of Nixon (September 1974) sparked outrage among Americans seeking accountability.
- Supporters argued it was necessary to heal the nation; critics claimed it established double standards of justice.
- Watergate fundamentally altered Americans' relationship with government, creating lasting cynicism.
- Public trust fell from 73% in 1958 to 36% by 1974, influencing political culture for generations.



Ollie Atkins, White House Chief Photographer, August 9, 1974
[Executive Office of the President of the United States](#)

Key Figure

Bob Woodward and Carl Bernstein

Washington Post investigative reporters

- Exposed the Watergate cover-up through persistent investigative reporting
- Cultivated the secret source "Deep Throat" (FBI official Mark Felt)

STRATEGY Investigative journalism (accountability reporting)

Resignation Speech

Sourcing

President Richard Nixon • August 8, 1974

"I have never been a quitter. To leave office before my term is completed is abhorrent to every instinct in my body. But as President, I must put the interest of America first... Therefore, I shall resign the Presidency effective at noon tomorrow. Vice President Ford will be sworn in as President."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

Facing near-certain impeachment after the release of the "smoking gun" tape, Nixon became the first U.S. president to resign. In this televised address, he explained his decision to the nation while insisting he had acted in the country's interest.

ANALYZE

Why does Nixon say he is resigning?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? President Richard Nixon	WHEN? August 8, 1974	WHY does it matter? Consider the author's purpose — a resignation speech is meant to shape how history remembers him.
--	--	--------------------------------	---

Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Watergate Scandal

Escándalo de Watergate

say: WAW-ter-gayt SKAN-dul

WS

A political scandal beginning with a 1972 break-in at Democratic headquarters that exposed abuses of power and forced Nixon to resign in 1974.

United States v. Nixon

Estados Unidos vs. Nixon

say: yoo-NY-ted stayts VER-sus NIK-sun

US

A 1974 Supreme Court ruling that the president is not above the law and must release the Watergate tapes.

Executive Privilege

Privilegio Ejecutivo

say: eg-ZEK-yoo-tiv PRIV-ul-ij

EP

A president's claimed right to keep some communications secret — rejected by the Court in the Watergate tapes case.

Ford's Pardon of Nixon

Indulto de Ford a Nixon

say: fordz PAR-dun

FS

President Gerald Ford's 1974 decision to pardon Nixon for any crimes, a choice that deepened public distrust of government.

Impeachment

Juicio Político

say: im-PEECH-ment

IM

The constitutional process for charging a president with serious wrongdoing; Nixon resigned before the House could impeach him.

Investigative Journalism

Periodismo de Investigación

say: in-VES-tih-gay-tiv JUR-nul-izm

IJ

In-depth reporting — like the Washington Post's Watergate coverage — that uncovers hidden wrongdoing by those in power.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Corroborate evidence across sources

MODEL PROMPT: One source is Nixon's resignation speech; another is the "smoking gun" tape. How do I use both to judge his guilt?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

The speech says he acted for America's good; the tape shows him directing a cover-up.

THINK ALOUD

To corroborate, I compare what different sources say — when the tape contradicts the speech, the tape is stronger evidence because it was recorded at the time and not meant to be public.

→ **Now you try:** Now you: explain which source better reveals Nixon's actual role in Watergate, and why.

Watergate — Timeline of a Constitutional Crisis

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes and the primary source excerpts, build a timeline of the Watergate scandal in order: the 1972 break-in at the Democratic headquarters, the cover-up, the Senate hearings and discovery of the White House tapes, United States v. Nixon (1974), and Nixon's resignation on August 9, 1974. For each event, add one sentence on why it mattered. Finish with a claim about what Watergate proved about the rule of law and the phrase “no one is above the law.”

DELIVERABLE

Completed timeline (5+ ordered events, each with a why-it-mattered note) plus a one-sentence claim on how the system of checks and balances responded to a president who broke the law.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Timeline with events pre-listed to place in order and a word bank (break-in, cover-up, tapes, United States v. Nixon, resignation). Honors: Analyze which branch of government did the most to hold Nixon accountable — the courts, Congress, the press, or public opinion? Defend with evidence.

Companion printable: [printables/unit-10/unit-10-timeline.html](https://www.troopstoteacher.com/printables/unit-10/unit-10-timeline.html)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

Why does Nixon say he is resigning?

- A** He was found guilty of crimes in court
- B** He wants to spend more time with his family
- C** He was forced out by the military
- D** He believes it is in the best interest of America

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

Why does Nixon say he is resigning?

- A** He was found guilty of crimes in court
- B** He wants to spend more time with his family
- C** He was forced out by the military
- D** He believes it is in the best interest of America ✓

Correct answer: D. Why: Nixon states he "must put the interest of America first" as his reason for resigning, framing it as a sacrifice despite it being "abhorrent" to him.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The Break-in Circumstances
- Media's Changing Role
- United States v. Nixon
- Ford's Pardon and Legacy of Distrust

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** **DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation**

Analyze which check on power did the most to hold Nixon accountable — the courts, Congress, the press, or public opinion? Defend your answer with evidence.

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain the Watergate scandal and why it led to Nixon's resignation. What did United States v. Nixon establish?

STANDARD

US.87

Emergence of Environmentalism

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Explain the emergence of environmentalism, including the creation of the Environmental Protection Agency and disasters such as Love Canal and Three Mile Island.

I CAN

I can explain the emergence of environmentalism, including the creation of the Environmental Protection Agency and disasters such as Love Canal and Three Mile Island.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1 **US.86** We just studied Watergate. Why did President Nixon resign, and what did the Supreme Court decide in United States v. Nixon?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What federal agency was created in 1970 to protect the environment?

✓ **ANSWER**

The Environmental Protection Agency (EPA).

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

A single book about pesticides, rivers so polluted they caught fire, and 20 million Americans marching on the first Earth Day — within a few years the United States created the EPA and passed sweeping laws to protect the air, water, and wildlife.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How does a nation go from ignoring pollution to passing major environmental laws in just a few years? What has to change first — the science, or the public's attention?

Factors Leading to the Environmental Movement

- Several factors sparked environmental awareness: Rachel Carson's "Silent Spring" (1962) exposed pesticide dangers and their ecological impact.
- Visible pollution plagued cities with smog, rivers with contamination, and coastlines with oil spills.
- Earth Day 1970 brought massive public demonstrations supporting environmental protection.
- Growing scientific understanding of ecological interconnections raised alarm about long-term consequences.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The environmental movement grew because ____, which led the government to ____.



Cecil W. Stoughton, U.S. National Park Service, April 22, 1970
[U.S. National Park Service \(NPGallery\); via Wikimedia Commons](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

EPA's Purpose and Functions

- Created in 1970, the Environmental Protection Agency consolidated federal environmental responsibilities.
- Its functions include setting pollution standards, enforcing environmental laws, conducting research, and regulating toxic substances.
- The EPA marked the federal government's commitment to environmental protection as a national priority, establishing America's framework for environmental regulation.

Love Canal Disaster

- In Niagara Falls, New York, a school and homes were built on a former chemical waste dump.
- By the 1970s, residents experienced high rates of birth defects and cancer.
- The federal government relocated 239 families and declared the area uninhabitable.
- This disaster led to the Superfund program for cleaning up toxic waste sites, demonstrating the long-term consequences of industrial pollution.

Three Mile Island Accident

- The 1979 nuclear accident in Pennsylvania involved a partial reactor meltdown, radiation release, and evacuation recommendations.
- While health impacts were limited, the incident heightened public fears about nuclear power safety, effectively ending nuclear plant construction in the United States for decades and strengthening arguments for alternative energy sources.

Key Figure

Rachel Carson

Marine biologist and author of "Silent Spring"

- Published "Silent Spring" (1962), exposing the dangers of pesticides like DDT
- Helped launch the modern environmental movement

STRATEGY Public awareness (science writing)

EPA Establishment Message

Close Reading

President Richard Nixon • July 9, 1970

"Our national government today is not structured to make a coordinated attack on the pollutants which debase the air we breathe, the water we drink, and the land that grows our food... The Environmental Protection Agency would be charged with protecting and enhancing the physical environment of the Nation."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

In July 1970, President Nixon sent Congress a message proposing a new Environmental Protection Agency to pull together pollution-control programs scattered across the federal government. It reflected the surging public demand for environmental action seen at the first Earth Day that April.

ANALYZE

What problem was the EPA created to address?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? President Richard Nixon	WHEN? July 9, 1970	WHY does it matter? Consider that Nixon is announcing a new federal agency to Congress — how does that official purpose shape what the message emphasizes?
--	--	------------------------------	--

Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Environmentalism

Ambientalismo

say: en-vy-run-MEN-tul-izm

EN

A movement that grew in the 1960s-70s to protect nature and public health from pollution and industrial harm.

Earth Day

Día de la Tierra

say: U^RTH day

ED

First held April 22, 1970, a nationwide event that raised public awareness and support for protecting the environment.

Three Mile Island

Three Mile Island

say: three myl EYE-lund

TM

A 1979 partial nuclear meltdown in Pennsylvania that heightened fears about nuclear power safety.

Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)

Agencia de Protección Ambiental

say: en-vy-run-MEN-tul pro-TEK-shun

EP

The federal agency created in 1970 to set and enforce standards for clean air, water, and land.

Love Canal

Love Canal

say: luv kuh-NAL

LC

A New York neighborhood built on buried toxic waste; its 1978 health crisis spurred federal cleanup laws like Superfund.

Clean Air Act

Ley de Aire Limpio

say: kleen AIR akt

CA

A landmark law (expanded 1970) authorizing the federal government to limit air pollution from industry and vehicles.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Explain cause and effect in a movement

MODEL PROMPT: Rachel Carson writes about vanishing birds. How do I connect that book to the creation of the EPA in 1970?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

"Silent Spring" raised public alarm about pollution, which built pressure for government action.

THINK ALOUD

To explain cause and effect, I trace the chain: a warning book raised awareness, awareness created public demand (Earth Day), and demand pushed government to act (the EPA).

→ **Now you try:** *Now you: name one cause of the environmental movement and one effect it produced, and connect them.*

The Rise of Environmentalism — Cause & Effect Chart

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes and the primary source excerpt, complete the Cause & Effect organizer for the modern environmental movement. In CAUSES, list what raised alarm (Rachel Carson's Silent Spring, polluted rivers and air, oil spills). In EFFECTS, trace the response — the first Earth Day in 1970, the creation of the EPA, the Clean Air Act and Clean Water Act, and the Endangered Species Act. Finish with a claim about how public awareness led to federal action.

DELIVERABLE

Completed Cause & Effect organizer (3+ causes, 3+ effects) plus a one-sentence claim on why the environmental movement grew into national law so quickly.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer with a word bank (Silent Spring, Earth Day, EPA, Clean Air Act, Endangered Species Act) to sort. Honors: Evaluate whether public pressure or government action did more to protect the environment in the 1970s. Argue with evidence.

Companion printable: [printables/unit-10/unit-10-cause-effect.html](https://www.troopertogether.com/printables/unit-10/unit-10-cause-effect.html)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

How did Senator Nelson describe the significance of Earth Day?

- A** A one-time event with limited impact
- B** Evidence of a broad new national concern cutting across generations
- C** A movement only for young people
- D** A political event for one party only

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did Senator Nelson describe the significance of Earth Day?

- A A one-time event with limited impact
- B Evidence of a broad new national concern cutting across generations ✓**
- C A movement only for young people
- D A political event for one party only

Correct answer: B. Why: Nelson described Earth Day as "dramatic evidence of a broad new national concern that cuts across generations and ideologies," uniting diverse Americans.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Factors Leading to the Environmental Movement
- EPA's Purpose and Functions
- Love Canal Disaster
- Three Mile Island Accident

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** **DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation**

Evaluate whether public pressure or government action did more to protect the environment in the 1970s. Argue with evidence.

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain what caused the modern environmental movement and describe two government responses to it.

STANDARD

US.88

Carter Administration Events

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Identify and explain the significant events of President Jimmy Carter's administration, including: Poor economy, Panama Canal Treaty, Camp David Accords, Energy crisis, Iran Hostage Crisis.

I CAN

I can identify and explain the significant events of President Jimmy Carter's administration, including the poor economy, Panama Canal Treaty, Camp David Accords, energy crisis, and Iran Hostage Crisis.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1 **US.87** In the last standard we studied the rise of environmentalism. What agency and what event helped launch the movement?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What 1978 agreement, brokered by Carter, made peace between Egypt and Israel?

✓ **ANSWER**

The Camp David Accords.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

President Carter brokered a historic peace between Egypt and Israel at Camp David — yet is often remembered for gas lines, high inflation, and 444 days in which 52 Americans were held hostage in Iran.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Can a president achieve a great foreign-policy success and still lose the public's confidence? What matters more to voters — events abroad, or problems they feel at home?

Economic Difficulties

- Carter faced "stagflation" — simultaneous high inflation (13.5% by 1980) and unemployment (7.6%).
- Energy costs soared, interest rates reached 20%, and economic growth stagnated.
- Carter's response included voluntary wage-price guidelines and Federal Reserve monetary tightening, but these measures proved insufficient to solve the complex economic crisis.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

President Carter's greatest success was ___, but his presidency was damaged by ___.

Energy Crisis Implications

- Two oil crises (1973-74, 1979) created gas shortages, long lines at stations, and economic disruption.
- Carter promoted energy conservation, created the Department of Energy, and called for reduced dependence on foreign oil.
- However, public frustration with gas lines and heating oil costs damaged his political standing and raised questions about American vulnerability to foreign energy suppliers.

Panama Canal Treaty

- The 1977 treaties gradually transferred canal control to Panama by 1999, ending the American colonial presence in Central America.
- While strategically sound (the canal was becoming militarily obsolete), the treaties faced fierce domestic opposition from conservatives who viewed them as signs of American weakness and retreat from global commitments.

Iran Hostage Crisis

- After the Shah's overthrow in 1979, Iranian revolutionaries seized the U.S. Embassy, holding 52 Americans hostage for 444 days.
- Carter's failed rescue mission and inability to secure release dominated his presidency's final year, contributing to perceptions of American weakness and his 1980 electoral defeat to Ronald Reagan.

Camp David Accords

- Carter mediated 13 days of negotiations between Egypt's Sadat and Israel's Begin, producing a framework for Middle East peace.
- Egypt recognized Israel and regained the Sinai Peninsula, while Israel withdrew from occupied Egyptian territory.
- This represented the first Arab-Israeli peace agreement and Carter's greatest foreign policy achievement.



Unknown; U.S. National Archives and Records Administration, September 17, 1978
[National Archives and Records Administration \(NARA\); via Wikimedia Commons](#)

Key Figure

President Jimmy Carter

39th President of the United States

- Brokered the 1978 Camp David Accords between Egypt and Israel
- Created the Department of Energy and promoted energy conservation

STRATEGY Diplomacy (personal mediation)

Camp David Accords Signing Statement

Contextualization

President Jimmy Carter • September 17, 1978

"During the last two weeks, the members of all three delegations have spent endless hours, day and night, talking, negotiating, grappling with problems that have divided their people for 30 years. Whenever there was a deadlock, they found new ways to break the barrier."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

In September 1978, Carter invited Egyptian President Anwar Sadat and Israeli Prime Minister Menachem Begin to the presidential retreat at Camp David for 13 days of intense, secret negotiations. The resulting framework led to the first peace treaty between Israel and an Arab nation.

ANALYZE

What did the Camp David Accords achieve?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? President Jimmy Carter	WHEN? September 17, 1978	WHY does it matter? Consider the setting — a signing ceremony is meant to celebrate and frame an achievement.
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Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Stagflation

say: stag-FLAY-shun

Estanflación

ST

An unusual 1970s economy combining high inflation, high unemployment, and slow growth at the same time.

Camp David Accords

say: kamp DAY-vid uh-KORDZ

Acuerdos de Camp David

CD

A 1978 peace agreement between Egypt and Israel brokered by President Carter, a major diplomatic success.

Iran Hostage Crisis

say: ih-RAN HOS-tij KRY-sis

Crisis de los Rehenes en Irán

IH

The 1979-81 seizure of 52 Americans at the U.S. embassy in Iran for 444 days, which damaged Carter's presidency.

Energy Crisis

say: EN-er-jee KRY-sis

Crisis Energética

EC

1970s fuel shortages and soaring gas prices, worsened by an OPEC oil embargo, that strained the U.S. economy.

Panama Canal Treaty

say: PAN-uh-mah kuh-NAL

Tratado del Canal de Panamá

PC

Carter-era treaties (1977) agreeing to hand control of the Panama Canal over to Panama by the year 2000.

Human Rights Diplomacy

say: HYOO-mun ryts dih-PLOH-muh-see

Diplomacia de Derechos Humanos

HR

Carter's foreign policy of pressuring other nations to respect their citizens' basic rights.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Weigh successes against setbacks

MODEL PROMPT: Carter brokered the Camp David Accords but was hurt by the Iran Hostage Crisis. How do I weigh these against each other?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Camp David was a historic diplomatic success; the hostage crisis was a prolonged failure that made him look weak.

THINK ALOUD

To weigh events, I judge each by its impact and how long it lasted — a lasting peace treaty versus a 444-day crisis that helped cost him reelection.

→ **Now you try:** *Now you: name Carter's biggest success and biggest setback, and explain which mattered more for his presidency.*

The Carter Years — HIPPO Source Analysis

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes and a Carter-era primary source, complete the HIPPO organizer: Historical context, Intended audience, Purpose, Point of view, and Overall significance. Then list the major events of Carter's presidency — the Camp David Accords (1978), the energy crisis and “malaise,” and the Iran Hostage Crisis — and note whether each was a success or a setback. Finish with a claim on how the hostage crisis affected Americans' confidence.

DELIVERABLE

Completed HIPPO organizer for one source, a labeled list of Carter's key events (success vs. setback), and a one-sentence claim on why the Camp David Accords are remembered as his greatest achievement.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: HIPPO organizer with guiding questions and a matching activity linking each event to success or setback. Honors: Evaluate whether Carter should be judged more by his foreign-policy successes or his domestic struggles. Defend with evidence.

Companion printable: [printables/unit-10/hippo-primary-source-organizer.html](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/printables/unit-10/hippo-primary-source-organizer.html)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

What crisis does Carter identify as threatening America?

- A** A military threat from the Soviet Union
- B** A crisis of confidence and loss of national unity and purpose
- C** An economic depression
- D** A constitutional crisis

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What crisis does Carter identify as threatening America?

- A A military threat from the Soviet Union
- B A crisis of confidence and loss of national unity and purpose** ✓

C An economic depression

D A constitutional crisis

Correct answer: B. Why: Carter describes "a crisis of confidence" that "strikes at the very heart and soul and spirit of our national will" and a "loss of a unity of purpose."

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Economic Difficulties
- Energy Crisis Implications
- Panama Canal Treaty
- Iran Hostage Crisis
- Camp David Accords

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate whether Carter should be judged more by his foreign-policy successes or his domestic struggles. Defend with evidence.

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Describe Carter's greatest foreign-policy success and the crisis that most damaged his presidency.

STANDARD

US.89

Reagan Administration Significance

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Analyze the significance of President Ronald Reagan's administration, including: Revitalization of national pride, Reaganomics, Iran-Contra affair, "War on Drugs", Strategic Defense Initiative, AIDS epidemic.

I CAN

I can analyze the significance of President Ronald Reagan's administration, including the revitalization of national pride, Reaganomics, Iran-Contra affair, "War on Drugs," Strategic Defense Initiative, and the AIDS epidemic.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1 **US.88** We just studied the Carter years. What was his greatest foreign-policy success, and what crisis hurt his presidency?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What was the name for Reagan's tax-cutting, supply-side economic policy?

✓ **ANSWER**

Reaganomics.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

Standing at the Berlin Wall, President Reagan demanded, “Mr. Gorbachev, tear down this wall!” — two years later it fell. Reagan cut taxes, built up the military, and restored a sense of national confidence, while critics pointed to deficits and the Iran-Contra affair.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Reagan believed lower taxes and a stronger military would revive America. How do you judge whether a president's economic and foreign policies actually worked — by the results at the time, or years later?

Strategies for Enhancing National Pride

- Reagan restored American confidence through optimistic rhetoric ("Morning in America"), a military buildup demonstrating strength, and successful foreign interventions (Grenada).
- His communication skills and personal charisma helped Americans feel proud of their country again after Vietnam, Watergate, and the Iran hostage crisis had damaged national morale.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

Reaganomics tried to help the economy by ____, while Reagan pressured the Soviet Union by ____.



Kennedy Space Center, NASA, January 28, 1986
[NASA \(Photo GPN-2004-00012\); via Wikimedia Commons](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Reaganomics Principles and Impacts

- Principles: Supply-side economics emphasizing tax cuts, deregulation, and reduced government spending (except defense).
- Impacts: Economic growth resumed and inflation fell, but income inequality increased and federal deficits soared.
- Tax cuts primarily benefited wealthy Americans, while social program cuts affected the poor, creating debates about fairness that continue today.

Strategic Defense Initiative

- "Star Wars" proposed a space-based missile defense system to protect against nuclear attack.
- Reagan believed this would make nuclear weapons "impotent and obsolete" while demonstrating American technological superiority.
- Critics argued it was technologically unfeasible and destabilizing to arms control, though some credit it with pressuring the Soviet Union.

Iran-Contra Affair

- The Reagan administration secretly sold arms to Iran to fund Nicaraguan Contras, violating congressional prohibitions.
- When exposed, it revealed illegal activities, damaged Reagan's credibility, and led to criminal convictions of several officials.
- The scandal raised questions about presidential knowledge and adherence to constitutional limits on executive power.

AIDS Epidemic Response

- Reagan's delayed and inadequate response to AIDS reflected social prejudices and conservative values.
- The administration initially ignored the crisis, providing minimal funding for research or prevention.
- This delayed response contributed to the epidemic's spread and thousands of preventable deaths, creating lasting criticism of Reagan's public health leadership.

Key Figure

President Ronald Reagan

40th President of the United States

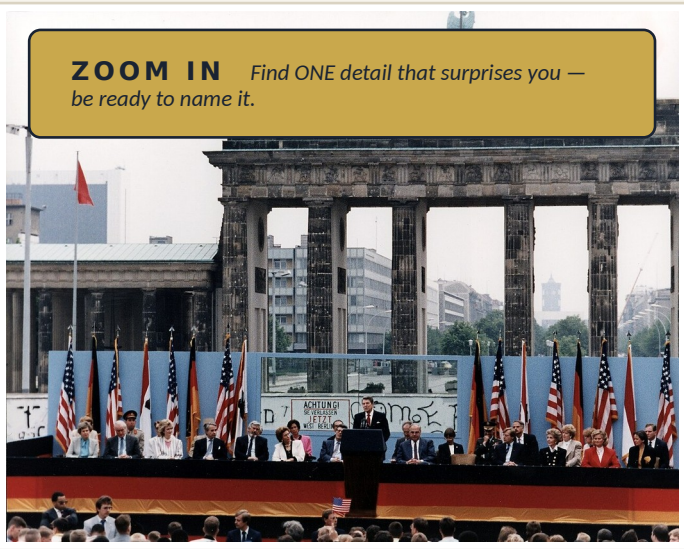
- Cut taxes and increased military spending under "Reaganomics"
- Challenged Soviet leader Gorbachev to "tear down this wall" (1987)

STRATEGY Communication ("the Great Communicator")

First Inaugural Address

Argumentation

President Ronald Reagan • January 20, 1981



Reagan White House Photographic Office, June 12, 1987
[National Archives and Records Administration \(NARA\)](#)

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.

"In this present crisis, government is not the solution to our problem; government is the problem. From time to time we've been tempted to believe that society has become too complex to be managed by self-rule... But if no one among us is capable of governing himself, then who among us has the capacity to govern someone else?"

CONTEXT

Reagan took office in January 1981 during high inflation and unemployment. His inaugural address announced a sharp turn away from the New Deal and Great Society tradition of activist government, summarizing his conservative philosophy in a single famous line.

ANALYZE

What is Reagan's view of government according to this speech?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	President Ronald Reagan	January 20, 1981	Consider that an inaugural address is designed to set the tone and philosophy for a whole presidency.

Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Reaganomics

say: ray-gun-OM-iks

Reaganomía

RE

President Reagan's economic plan of tax cuts, reduced regulation, and lower domestic spending to spur growth (supply-side economics).

Supply-Side Economics

say: suh-PLY syd ee-kuh-NOM-iks

Economía de la Oferta

SS

The theory behind Reaganomics that cutting taxes on businesses and the wealthy encourages investment and benefits the whole economy.

Strategic Defense Initiative

say: struh-TEE-jik dee-FENS

Iniciativa de Defensa Estratégica

SD

Reagan's proposed 1983 space-based missile-defense system, nicknamed 'Star Wars,' to intercept Soviet nuclear attacks.

Iran-Contra Affair

say: ih-RAN KON-truh uh-FAIR

Caso Irán-Contra

IC

A 1980s scandal in which officials secretly sold arms to Iran and used the money to fund rebels in Nicaragua.

War on Drugs

say: wor on DRUGZ

Guerra contra las Drogas

WO

Expanded 1980s federal efforts to stop drug use and trafficking through tougher laws and enforcement.

AIDS Epidemic

say: aydz ep-ih-DEM-ik

Epidemia del SIDA

AE

The public-health crisis of the 1980s from a deadly new disease; the government's slow response drew wide criticism.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Analyze significance from multiple angles

MODEL PROMPT: Reagan is praised for national pride and criticized for the AIDS response. How do I analyze his significance fairly?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Reagan restored confidence and pressured the USSR, but his AIDS and Iran-Contra records drew serious criticism.

THINK ALOUD

To analyze significance, I look at both achievements and failures rather than picking only one side — a president can be transformative and flawed at the same time.

→ **Now you try:** *Now you: name one Reagan achievement and one criticism, and explain how both shape his historical significance.*

The Reagan Era — Cause & Effect Chart

Groups of 3

18 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes and Reagan's "Tear Down This Wall" speech excerpt, complete the Cause & Effect organizer. In CAUSES, list the conditions Reagan responded to (high inflation and unemployment, the ongoing Cold War). In EFFECTS, trace his policies and their results — Reaganomics and tax cuts, the military buildup, and increased pressure on the Soviet Union that helped bring the Cold War toward its end. Finish with a claim about how Reagan's policies reshaped the economy and the Cold War.

DELIVERABLE

Completed Cause & Effect organizer (3+ causes, 3+ effects) plus a one-sentence claim on Reagan's most significant legacy.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer with a word bank (Reaganomics, tax cuts, military buildup, Cold War pressure, Berlin Wall) to place. Honors: Evaluate whether Reagan's economic policy or his Cold War strategy had the greater long-term impact. Argue with evidence.

Companion printable: [printables/unit-10/unit-10-cause-effect.html](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/printables/unit-10/unit-10-cause-effect.html)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

What is Reagan's view of government according to this speech?

- A** Government should expand its role in society
- B** Government and business should be partners
- C** Government expertise is needed for complex problems
- D** Government itself is the problem, not the solution

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What is Reagan's view of government according to this speech?

- A** Government should expand its role in society
- B** Government and business should be partners
- C** Government expertise is needed for complex problems
- D** Government itself is the problem, not the solution ✓

Correct answer: D. Why: Reagan explicitly states "government is not the solution to our problem; government is the problem," expressing his conservative philosophy of limited government.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Strategies for Enhancing National Pride
- Reaganomics Principles and Impacts
- Strategic Defense Initiative
- Iran-Contra Affair
- AIDS Epidemic Response

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate whether Reagan's economic policy or his Cold War strategy had the greater long-term impact on the United States. Argue with evidence.

EXIT TICKET

DOK 3

Explain the main ideas of Reaganomics and describe how Reagan approached the Cold War.

STANDARD

US.90

George H.W. Bush Administration

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the significant events of President George H.W. Bush's administration, including the invasion of Panama and the Gulf War.

I CAN

I can describe the significant events of President George H.W. Bush's administration, including the invasion of Panama and the Gulf War.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1 **US.89** In the last standard we studied the Reagan era. What was “Reaganomics,” and how did Reagan pressure the Soviet Union?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What 1991 war did George H.W. Bush lead a coalition to win?

✓ **ANSWER**

The Persian Gulf War (Operation Desert Storm).

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In a single presidency, George H.W. Bush watched the Berlin Wall fall, the Soviet Union collapse, and led a global coalition to victory in the Persian Gulf War — leaving the United States as the world's only superpower.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

When the Cold War ended and America became the world's only superpower, what new responsibilities — and new dangers — came with standing alone at the top?

Panama Invasion

- Operation Just Cause (1989) removed dictator Manuel Noriega, who had been indicted for drug trafficking and was threatening American citizens.
- The invasion demonstrated post-Cold War American willingness to use military force for law enforcement and humanitarian purposes, establishing precedents for future interventions.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

During the Bush presidency, ___ happened, which meant that the United States ___.

Gulf War Context and Outcomes

- When Iraq invaded Kuwait (1990), Bush assembled an international coalition and obtained UN authorization for military action.
- Operation Desert Storm (1991) quickly liberated Kuwait with minimal coalition casualties, demonstrating American military superiority, effective international diplomacy, and the potential for multilateral action in the post-Cold War world.



Tech. Sgt. David McLeod, U.S. Air Force, 1991 [U.S. Department of Defense](#)

Fall of Berlin Wall and Soviet Collapse (Honors)

- The Berlin Wall's fall (1989) symbolized communism's collapse and the Cold War's end.
- Bush managed this transition carefully, avoiding triumphalism that might provoke Soviet hardliners while supporting German reunification.
- The Soviet Union's dissolution (1991) left America as the world's sole superpower, creating new global responsibilities and challenges for American foreign policy.



Bush White House Photographic Office, November 21, 1989
[National Archives and Records Administration \(NARA 186404\); via Wikimedia Commons](#)

Key Figure

President George H.W. Bush

41st President of the United States

- Assembled an international coalition to liberate Kuwait in the Gulf War (1991)
- Guided U.S. policy through the fall of the Berlin Wall and Soviet collapse

STRATEGY Coalition-building (multilateral diplomacy)

Address on the Gulf War

President George H.W. Bush • January 16, 1991

Contextualization

"Five months ago, Saddam Hussein started this cruel war against Kuwait. Tonight, the battle has been joined... Our objectives are clear: Saddam Hussein's forces will leave Kuwait. The legitimate government of Kuwait will be restored to its rightful place, and Kuwait will once again be free."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

After Iraq invaded Kuwait in August 1990, Bush built a broad international coalition and secured UN backing. On January 16, 1991, as Operation Desert Storm began, he addressed the nation to explain the war's limited and specific goals.

ANALYZE

What were the stated objectives of the Gulf War?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? President George H.W. Bush	WHEN? January 16, 1991	WHY does it matter? Consider that a wartime address is meant to justify military action and rally the public.
--	---	----------------------------------	---

Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Persian Gulf War

say: PER-zhun gulf WOR

Guerra del Golfo Pérsico

PG

A 1991 U.S.-led coalition war that drove Iraqi forces out of Kuwait after Iraq's 1990 invasion.

Operation Desert Storm

say: op-er-AY-shun DEZ-ert storm

Operación Tormenta del Desierto

OD

The 1991 military campaign that quickly liberated Kuwait from Iraqi occupation.

Fall of the Berlin Wall

say: fawl of ber-LIN WAWL

Caída del Muro de Berlín

FO

The 1989 opening of the wall dividing East and West Berlin, a symbol of the Cold War's end.

Collapse of the Soviet Union

say: kuh-LAPS of SOH-vee-et

Colapso de la Unión Soviética

CO

The 1991 breakup of the USSR into independent nations, ending the Cold War.

Panama Invasion

say: PAN-uh-mah in-VAY-zhun

Invasión de Panamá

PI

The 1989 U.S. military action that removed Panamanian dictator Manuel Noriega from power.

Americans with Disabilities Act

say: uh-MER-ih-kunz with dis-uh-BIL-ih-teez

Ley de Estadounidenses con Discapacidades

AW

A 1990 law signed by President Bush banning discrimination against people with disabilities.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Place events in historical context

MODEL PROMPT: The Gulf War and the Soviet collapse both happened under Bush. How do I explain why they mark a new era?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Both events came right after the Cold War ended, leaving the U.S. as the world's only superpower.

THINK ALOUD

To place events in context, I ask what came before — the Cold War shaped 40 years, so its end changed how America used its power abroad.

→ **Now you try:** *Now you: explain how the end of the Cold War changed America's role in the world during Bush's presidency.*

The End of the Cold War — Timeline

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes, build a timeline of the George H.W. Bush years in order: the fall of the Berlin Wall (1989), the reunification of Germany, the collapse of the Soviet Union (1991), and the Persian Gulf War / Operation Desert Storm (1991). For each event, add one sentence on its significance. Finish with a claim about what it meant for the United States to become the world's only superpower.

DELIVERABLE

Completed timeline (4+ ordered events, each with a significance note) plus a one-sentence claim on how the end of the Cold War changed America's role in the world.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Timeline with events pre-listed to place in order and a word bank (Berlin Wall, German reunification, Soviet collapse, Desert Storm). Honors: Analyze whether the peaceful end of the Cold War or the swift victory in the Gulf War did more to define Bush's presidency. Defend with evidence.

Companion printable: [printables/unit-10/unit-10-timeline.html](https://www.troopstoteacher.com/printables/unit-10/unit-10-timeline.html)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

How did Bush describe the end of the Soviet Union?

- A** As a dangerous development for the world
- B** As a victory for democracy, freedom, and American values
- C** As having no significance for America
- D** As the beginning of a new war

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did Bush describe the end of the Soviet Union?

- A As a dangerous development for the world
- B As a victory for democracy, freedom, and American values** ✓
- C As having no significance for America
- D As the beginning of a new war

Correct answer: B. **Why:** Bush called it "a victory for democracy and freedom" and "a victory for the moral force of our values" that every American should take pride in.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Panama Invasion
- Gulf War Context and Outcomes
- Fall of Berlin Wall and Soviet Collapse (Honors)

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Analyze whether the peaceful end of the Cold War or the swift Gulf War victory did more to define Bush's presidency. Defend with evidence.

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Describe two major events of the George H.W. Bush presidency and explain their significance.

STANDARD

US.91

Clinton Administration Events

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Summarize the events of President Bill Clinton's administration, including: Welfare-to-work, Balanced budget, NAFTA, Scandals and subsequent impeachment hearings.

I CAN

I can summarize the events of President Bill Clinton's administration, including welfare-to-work, balanced budget, NAFTA, and scandals and subsequent impeachment hearings.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.90 We just studied George H.W. Bush. What two world-changing events happened during his presidency?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What 1993 free-trade agreement linked the U.S., Canada, and Mexico?

✓ **ANSWER**

NAFTA (the North American Free Trade Agreement).

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

The 1990s brought a booming economy, a balanced budget, and free-trade deals like NAFTA — alongside welfare reform and only the second presidential impeachment in American history.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Free-trade agreements like NAFTA promised cheaper goods and new markets, but also sent some jobs overseas. When a policy helps the country as a whole but hurts some workers, is it worth it?

NAFTA Goals and Outcomes

- The North American Free Trade Agreement (1994) eliminated trade barriers between the U.S., Canada, and Mexico.
- Supporters argued it would increase trade and economic growth.
- Critics claimed it would cost American jobs and exploit Mexican workers.
- Results were mixed — trade increased significantly, but manufacturing jobs moved to Mexico, intensifying debates about globalization.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

NAFTA was created to ____, and in the 1990s the U.S. economy ____.

Welfare-to-Work Transition

- The 1996 Personal Responsibility and Work Opportunity Act replaced Aid to Families with Dependent Children (AFDC) with Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF).
- The new system required work or job training and imposed time limits on benefits.
- Welfare rolls declined dramatically, but poverty reduction was limited, raising questions about whether people left poverty or just left welfare.

Scandals and Impeachment

- Clinton faced multiple scandals, including Whitewater real estate investments and sexual harassment allegations.
- The Monica Lewinsky affair led to impeachment charges for perjury and obstruction of justice.
- The House impeached Clinton, but the Senate acquitted him, reflecting partisan divisions and debates about whether personal conduct should determine political consequences.

Balanced Budget Significance

- Clinton achieved the first balanced federal budget since 1969, aided by economic growth, tax increases on high earners, and spending restraint.
- Budget surpluses in the late 1990s reduced national debt and demonstrated fiscal responsibility, though this achievement proved temporary as surpluses disappeared under subsequent administrations.

Key Figure

President Bill Clinton

42nd President of the United States

- Signed NAFTA and achieved the first balanced federal budget since 1969
- Was impeached by the House but acquitted by the Senate (1998-1999)

STRATEGY Centrist politics ("triangulation")

NAFTA Signing Statement

Sourcing

President Bill Clinton • December 8, 1993



Ralph Alswang, White House Photographic Office, September 14, 1993
[Clinton White House](#)

"NAFTA means jobs. American jobs, and good-paying American jobs. If I didn't believe that, I wouldn't support this agreement... NAFTA will generate these jobs by opening the largest, richest market in the world — right in our own hemisphere, right next door."

CONTEXT

In December 1993, Clinton signed legislation implementing NAFTA, a free-trade agreement that had divided both parties. He argued the deal would create American jobs by opening new markets, though critics warned it would send manufacturing jobs abroad.

ANALYZE

How did Clinton justify supporting NAFTA?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	President Bill Clinton	December 8, 1993	Consider the author's purpose — a signing statement is meant to sell the benefits of a policy.

Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

NAFTA

say: NAF-tuh

TLCAN

NA

The 1994 North American Free Trade Agreement removing most trade barriers among the U.S., Canada, and Mexico.

Balanced Budget

say: BAL-unst BUJ-it

Presupuesto Equilibrado

BB

A federal budget in which spending does not exceed revenue; achieved in the late 1990s under Clinton.

Contract with America

say: KON-trakt with uh-MER-ih-kuh

Contrato con América

CW

A 1994 Republican campaign plan led by Newt Gingrich promising smaller government and balanced budgets.

Welfare-to-Work Reform

say: WEL-fair to wurk ree-FORM

Reforma de Asistencia Social

WT

A 1996 Clinton-era law that limited welfare benefits and required recipients to find work.

Clinton Impeachment

say: KLIN-tun im-PEECH-ment

Juicio Político a Clinton

CI

The 1998 House impeachment of President Clinton for perjury and obstruction; the Senate acquitted him in 1999.

Dot-com Boom

say: dot-KOM boom

Auge de las Puntocom

DC

The late-1990s surge in internet-based businesses and stock values, which later crashed in 2000-01.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Summarize a presidency's key events

MODEL PROMPT: Clinton's years included a balanced budget, NAFTA, and impeachment. How do I summarize them clearly?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Clinton oversaw prosperity and a balanced budget, expanded free trade, and was impeached but acquitted.

THINK ALOUD

To summarize, I group events by theme — economic policy (budget, NAFTA, welfare) and political controversy (scandals, impeachment) — instead of just listing them.

→ **Now you try:** Now you: write a one-sentence summary of the Clinton presidency that includes both an achievement and a controversy.

The Clinton Years — Cause & Effect Chart

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes and the NAFTA primary source, complete the Cause & Effect organizer for the Clinton presidency. In CAUSES, list the issues Clinton faced (a globalizing economy, budget deficits, debate over trade). In EFFECTS, trace the results — NAFTA and expanded free trade, the 1990s economic boom and budget surplus, welfare reform, and the political conflict that led to impeachment. Finish with a claim about globalization's effect on American workers.

DELIVERABLE

Completed Cause & Effect organizer (3+ causes, 3+ effects) plus a one-sentence claim on whether free trade helped or hurt American workers in the 1990s.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer with a word bank (NAFTA, free trade, budget surplus, welfare reform, globalization) to sort. Honors: Evaluate whether the economic prosperity of the 1990s or the political battles of the era better defines the Clinton presidency. Argue with evidence.

Companion printable: [printables/unit-10/unit-10-cause-effect.html](https://www.troopstoteacher.com/printables/unit-10/unit-10-cause-effect.html)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

How did Clinton justify supporting NAFTA?

- A** It would reduce immigration from Mexico
- B** It would weaken Canada economically
- C** It would create American jobs by opening new markets
- D** It would eliminate all trade barriers worldwide

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did Clinton justify supporting NAFTA?

- A It would reduce immigration from Mexico
- B It would weaken Canada economically
- C It would create American jobs by opening new markets** ✓
- D It would eliminate all trade barriers worldwide

Correct answer: C. **Why:** Clinton states "NAFTA means jobs. American jobs, and good-paying American jobs" and that it "will generate these jobs by opening the largest, richest market."

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- NAFTA Goals and Outcomes
- Welfare-to-Work Transition
- Scandals and Impeachment
- Balanced Budget Significance

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate whether the prosperity of the 1990s or the political battles of the era better defines the Clinton presidency. Argue with evidence.

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain what NAFTA was and describe the state of the U.S. economy in the 1990s under Clinton.

STANDARD

US.92

September 11th Impact

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the impact of the September 11, 2001 terrorist attacks on the World Trade Center and the Pentagon, including: the response of President George W. Bush, wars in Afghanistan and Iraq, and continued efforts to combat terrorism globally.

I CAN

I can describe the impact of the September 11, 2001 terrorist attacks on the World Trade Center and the Pentagon, including the response of President George W. Bush, wars in Afghanistan and Iraq, and continued efforts to combat terrorism globally.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1 **US.91** In the last standard we studied the Clinton years. What was NAFTA, and what economic milestone did the 1990s reach?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

On what date did terrorists attack the World Trade Center and the Pentagon?

✓ **ANSWER**

September 11, 2001.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

On the morning of September 11, 2001, hijacked planes struck the World Trade Center and the Pentagon, killing nearly 3,000 people — and changing American security, foreign policy, and daily life in ways that still shape the country today.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

After 9/11, Americans accepted new security measures — airport screening, the Patriot Act, expanded surveillance. How does a free society decide how much liberty to trade for safety?

Bush's Domestic and International Response

- Domestically, Bush created the Department of Homeland Security, signed the USA PATRIOT Act expanding surveillance powers, increased airport security, and launched domestic surveillance programs.
- Internationally, he declared a "War on Terror," demanded the Taliban surrender Osama bin Laden, and assembled an international coalition for the Afghanistan invasion to destroy al-Qaeda and remove the Taliban.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

After the September 11th attacks, the United States responded by ____, in order to ____.



Andrea Booher, FEMA News Photo, September 28, 2001
[Federal Emergency Management Agency \(FEMA\)](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Afghanistan War

- Justified as self-defense against al-Qaeda and the Taliban harboring terrorists, the Afghanistan invasion initially succeeded in removing the Taliban from power.
- However, it evolved into the longest war in American history with limited success in nation-building.
- Questions persisted about exit strategies and whether military force could transform Afghan society.

Iraq War

- Bush claimed Saddam Hussein possessed weapons of mass destruction and supported terrorism.
- The invasion succeeded militarily but created regional instability, sectarian violence, and damaged American credibility when the WMD claims proved false.
- The war raised fundamental questions about intelligence, justification for preemptive war, and occupation strategies.

Global Counter-terrorism Efforts

- The "War on Terror" included military operations in multiple countries, intelligence sharing with allies, financial tracking of terrorist organizations, and diplomatic pressure on nations supporting terrorism.
- Success in preventing major attacks on American soil was offset by concerns about civil liberties, international law violations, and whether military approaches address terrorism's root causes.

Key Figure

President George W. Bush

43rd President of the United States

- Led the U.S. response to the September 11, 2001 terrorist attacks
- Launched the "War on Terror" and wars in Afghanistan and Iraq

STRATEGY Assertive foreign policy (War on Terror)

Address to the Nation

President George W. Bush • September 11, 2001

Contextualization

"Today, our fellow citizens, our way of life, our very freedom came under attack in a series of deliberate and deadly terrorist acts... Thousands of lives were suddenly ended by evil, despicable acts of terror. The pictures of airplanes flying into buildings, fires burning, huge structures collapsing, have filled us with disbelief, terrible sadness, and a quiet, unyielding anger."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

On the evening of September 11, 2001, hours after hijacked planes destroyed the World Trade Center and struck the Pentagon, Bush addressed a shaken nation from the Oval Office. His words framed the attacks as an assault on American freedom itself.

ANALYZE

How does Bush describe the September 11 attacks?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? President George W. Bush	WHEN? September 11, 2001	WHY does it matter? Consider that a president speaking hours after a tragedy is trying to reassure and unite a frightened nation.
--	---	------------------------------------	---

Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

September 11, 2001 Attacks

Ataques del 11 de Septiembre

say: sep-TEM-ber ee-LEV-en uh-TAKS

SA

Coordinated al-Qaeda terrorist attacks that destroyed the World Trade Center and struck the Pentagon, killing nearly 3,000 people.

USA PATRIOT Act

Ley Patriota

say: yoo-es-AY PAY-tree-ut akt

UP

A 2001 law expanding government surveillance powers to prevent terrorism, criticized by some as a threat to civil liberties.

War in Afghanistan

Guerra en Afganistán

say: wor in af-GAN-ih-stan

WI

The U.S. war begun in 2001 to remove the Taliban and destroy al-Qaeda bases after the 9/11 attacks.

War on Terror

Guerra contra el Terrorismo

say: wor on TER-er

WO

The U.S. global campaign after 9/11 to defeat terrorist groups and the nations that harbored them.

Department of Homeland Security

Departamento de Seguridad Nacional

say: dee-PART-ment of HOHM-land

DO

A federal department created in 2002 to coordinate protection of the U.S. against terrorism and disasters.

Iraq War

Guerra de Irak

say: ih-RAK wor

IW

The 2003 U.S.-led invasion that toppled Saddam Hussein, launched on claims of weapons of mass destruction.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Trace the impact of a single event

MODEL PROMPT: 9/11 was one day. How do I trace its impact across security, wars, and civil liberties?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

9/11 led to new security agencies, the PATRIOT Act, and wars in Afghanistan and Iraq.

THINK ALOUD

To trace impact, I follow the consequences outward from the event — one attack reshaped domestic security, foreign policy, and debates over privacy.

→ **Now you try:** *Now you: name one domestic and one international way 9/11 changed the United States.*

September 11th — Pre-9/11 vs. Post-9/11 America Venn

Pairs

18 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes and the primary source, complete the Venn diagram comparing America BEFORE and AFTER September 11, 2001. In the outer circles, record what was distinct to each period (open airports and looser security before; the Department of Homeland Security, the Patriot Act, airport screening, and the War on Terror after). In the overlap, record what stayed the same (American resilience, national unity). Finish with a claim about how 9/11 changed the balance between security and civil liberties.

DELIVERABLE

Completed Venn diagram (2+ items per section, including the shared overlap) plus a one-sentence claim on the biggest lasting change 9/11 brought to daily American life.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Venn diagram with sentence stems and a word bank (Homeland Security, Patriot Act, airport security, War on Terror, national unity) to place. Honors: Analyze whether the security measures adopted after 9/11 protected Americans or went too far in limiting freedoms. Defend with evidence.

Companion printable: [printables/unit-10/venn-pre-9-11-vs-post-9-11-america.html](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/printables/unit-10/venn-pre-9-11-vs-post-9-11-america.html)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

How does Bush describe the September 11 attacks?

A As deliberate attacks on American freedom that caused sadness and anger

B As accidents caused by mechanical failures

C As minor incidents requiring limited response

D As actions by a specific foreign government

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How does Bush describe the September 11 attacks?

- A** As deliberate attacks on American freedom that caused sadness and anger ✓
- B** As accidents caused by mechanical failures
- C** As minor incidents requiring limited response
- D** As actions by a specific foreign government

Correct answer: A. **Why:** Bush describes "deliberate and deadly terrorist acts" where "our very freedom came under attack," causing "terrible sadness, and a quiet, unyielding anger."

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Bush's Domestic and International Response
- Afghanistan War
- Iraq War
- Global Counter-terrorism Efforts

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Analyze whether the security measures adopted after 9/11 protected Americans or went too far in limiting freedoms. Defend your position with evidence.

EXIT TICKET

DOK 3

Explain how the September 11th attacks changed American security and foreign policy. Give at least two specific changes.

STANDARD

US.93

Increasing Role of Women and Minorities

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the increasing role of women and minorities in the American military, politics, and economy, including: Hillary Clinton, Sandra Day O'Connor, Nancy Pelosi, Colin Powell, Condoleezza Rice. (TCA)

I CAN

I can describe the increasing role of women and minorities in the American military, politics, and economy, including Hillary Clinton, Sandra Day O'Connor, Nancy Pelosi, Colin Powell, and Condoleezza Rice.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.92 We just studied the September 11th attacks. Name two ways the U.S. government responded.

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Who was the first woman appointed to the U.S. Supreme Court?

✓ **ANSWER**

Sandra Day O'Connor (1981).

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

Sandra Day O'Connor became the first woman on the Supreme Court, Colin Powell and Condoleezza Rice led American foreign policy, and Nancy Pelosi became the first woman Speaker of the House — breaking barriers that had stood for the entire history of the republic.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

When someone becomes the “first” to hold a powerful office, why does that matter beyond just one person's career? What does it change for everyone who comes after?

Hillary Clinton's Contributions

- First Lady (1993-2001), U.S. Senator from New York (2001-2009), Secretary of State (2009-2013), and the first woman nominated for president by a major party (2016).
- She advocated for healthcare reform, women's rights, and children's issues while breaking gender barriers in American politics at the highest levels.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

___ broke a barrier by becoming the first ___ to ___, which was significant because ___.

Colin Powell's Leadership

- First Black Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff (1989-1993), he oversaw Gulf War success and served as Secretary of State (2001-2005).
- His military leadership and diplomatic service demonstrated minority advancement in national security positions while maintaining broad public respect across political lines.

Sandra Day O'Connor's Pioneering Impact

- First woman Supreme Court Justice (1981-2006), appointed by Reagan.
- Her moderate conservative positions often provided swing votes on crucial cases.
- She opened the door for women in the legal profession's highest position and demonstrated that gender need not determine judicial philosophy.

Condoleezza Rice's Foreign Policy Role

- First Black woman National Security Advisor (2001-2005) and Secretary of State (2005-2009).
- Her expertise in Soviet/Russian affairs and close relationship with President Bush made her influential in post-9/11 foreign policy, particularly regarding Iraq and democracy promotion.

Nancy Pelosi's Political Leadership

- First woman Speaker of the House (2007-2011, 2019-2023), the highest-ranking woman in American government.
- She led Democratic opposition to Bush policies, shepherded Obama's legislative agenda including healthcare reform, and managed Trump's impeachment proceedings, demonstrating women's leadership in legislative politics.

Key Figures

Sandra Day O'Connor

First woman U.S. Supreme Court Justice



Unknown; U.S. federal government, 1994 [U.S. Supreme Court](#)

- Became the first woman appointed to the Supreme Court (1981)
- Often cast the deciding swing vote on major cases

STRATEGY Institutional leadership (breaking barriers)

Colin Powell

First Black Chairman of the Joint Chiefs and Secretary of State

- First African American Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff (1989)
- First African American Secretary of State (2001)

STRATEGY Public service (military and diplomacy)

Sandra Day O'Connor Confirmation Statement

Argumentation

Sandra Day O'Connor • September 1981

"It is a great honor for me to be the first woman to be nominated for a place on the Supreme Court. It is an honor to be selected by the President of the United States and an honor to be confirmed by the Senate... I hope that my appointment will serve to inspire other women to aspire to positions of leadership."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

When President Reagan nominated Sandra Day O'Connor in 1981, she became the first woman ever named to the Supreme Court. In her confirmation statement she reflected on the meaning of the milestone for women across the country.

ANALYZE

What significance did O'Connor attach to her appointment?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it? Sandra Day O'Connor	WHEN? September 1981	WHY does it matter? Consider that O'Connor is speaking as a barrier-breaker aware her words will be heard by women nationwide.
--	--	--------------------------------	--

Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Sandra Day O'Connor

say: SAN-druh day oh-KON-er

Sandra Day O'Connor

SD

The first woman to serve on the U.S. Supreme Court, appointed in 1981.

Condoleezza Rice

say: kon-duh-LEE-zuh RYS

Condoleezza Rice

CR

The first African American woman U.S. Secretary of State (2005), a key foreign-policy leader.

Nancy Pelosi

say: NAN-see puh-LOH-see

Nancy Pelosi

NP

The first woman elected Speaker of the U.S. House of Representatives (2007).

Colin Powell

say: KOH-lin POW-ul

Colin Powell

CP

The first African American U.S. Secretary of State (2001) and Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff.

Hillary Clinton

say: HIL-uh-ree KLIN-tun

Hillary Clinton

HC

U.S. Senator, Secretary of State, and the first woman to win a major party's presidential nomination (2016).

Glass Ceiling

say: glas SEE-ling

Techo de Cristal

GC

An invisible barrier that has kept women and minorities from reaching the highest positions in business and government.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Explain historical significance of individuals

MODEL PROMPT: O'Connor, Powell, and Rice all achieved "firsts." How do I explain why these firsts matter?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Each broke a barrier — first woman on the Court, first Black Secretary of State — opening doors for others.

THINK ALOUD

To explain significance, I ask what changed because of the person — a "first" matters because it proves a role is open to groups once excluded.

→ **Now you try:** *Now you: pick one leader from this standard and explain what barrier they broke and why it mattered.*

Expanding Opportunity — Women & Minorities Cause & Effect

Groups of 3

18 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes, complete the Cause & Effect organizer for the expanding roles of women and minorities. In CAUSES, list the barriers and the movements that challenged them (Title IX, affirmative action, the women's and civil-rights movements). In EFFECTS, trace the breakthroughs — Sandra Day O'Connor as the first woman on the Supreme Court, Colin Powell and other minority leaders, and rising participation in politics, business, and the professions. Finish with a claim about how these breakthroughs changed who holds power in America.

DELIVERABLE

Completed Cause & Effect organizer (3+ causes, 3+ effects) plus a one-sentence claim on the most significant breakthrough for women and minorities in this era.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer with a word bank (Title IX, affirmative action, Sandra Day O'Connor, Colin Powell, glass ceiling) to sort. Honors: Evaluate whether laws or individual trailblazers did more to expand opportunity for women and minorities. Argue with evidence.

Companion printable: [printables/unit-10/unit-10-cause-effect.html](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/printables/unit-10/unit-10-cause-effect.html)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

What significance did O'Connor attach to her appointment?

- A** It would change the court's political balance
- B** It could inspire other women to seek leadership positions
- C** It would lead to more conservative rulings
- D** It was purely a personal achievement

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What significance did O'Connor attach to her appointment?

- A It would change the court's political balance
- B It could inspire other women to seek leadership positions ✓**
- C It would lead to more conservative rulings
- D It was purely a personal achievement

Correct answer: B. Why: O'Connor states "I hope that my appointment will serve to inspire other women to aspire to positions of leadership."

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Hillary Clinton's Contributions
- Colin Powell's Leadership
- Sandra Day O'Connor's Pioneering Impact
- Condoleezza Rice's Foreign Policy Role
- Nancy Pelosi's Political Leadership

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** **DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation**

Evaluate whether laws (like Title IX and affirmative action) or individual trailblazers did more to expand opportunity for women and minorities. Argue with evidence.

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Describe two women or minority leaders from this era and explain why their achievements were significant.

STANDARD

US.94

Communication Methods Evolution

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Compare and contrast commonly used methods of communication from 1970 to today, and analyze the impact they have had on society.

I CAN

I can compare and contrast commonly used methods of communication from 1970 to today, and analyze the impact they have had on society.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.93 In the last standard we studied expanding roles for women and minorities. Name one barrier-breaking leader and what office they held.

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What global computer network transformed communication starting in the 1990s?

✓ **ANSWER**

The Internet.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In the 1970s, Americans communicated by letters, landline phones, and printed newspapers. Within a generation, the personal computer, the Internet, email, cell phones, and social media transformed how people talk, work, shop, and share information.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

The digital revolution made communication instant and global. What did society gain from that speed — and what, like privacy or face-to-face connection, might it have lost?

1970s Communication Technologies

- Landline telephones were the primary voice communication method.
- Television, dominated by three major networks, provided news and entertainment.
- Radio remained important for music and local news.
- Newspapers were the primary source for detailed news coverage.
- Mail served as the standard written communication method.
- Communication was slower, more deliberate, and geographically constrained.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

In the 1970s Americans communicated by ____, but today they use ____, which changed society by ____.



FA2010 (photographer); rights holder released into public domain, 1981 (photographed c. 2011) [Museum für Angewandte Kunst](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Present-Day Communication Methods

- Smartphones integrate voice, text, internet, and multimedia capabilities.
- Social media platforms like Facebook, Twitter, and Instagram enable instant global communication.
- Email is the primary business and formal communication method.
- Video conferencing through Zoom and similar platforms allows face-to-face remote communication.
- Streaming services have replaced traditional television viewing patterns.

Comparing Characteristics and Limitations

- 1970s advantages: more face-to-face interaction, deeper news analysis, less information overload. 1970s limitations: slower communication, limited information access, geographic barriers.
- Present advantages: instant global communication, unlimited information access, multimedia capabilities.
- Present limitations: information overload, privacy concerns, reduced attention spans, and cybersecurity threats.

Societal Impact

- Communication evolution has transformed culture (global connectivity, viral content), the economy (e-commerce, remote work), governance (social media campaigns, digital democracy), and relationships (online dating, long-distance connections, but also reduced face-to-face interaction and increased isolation).
- These changes continue to reshape American society in profound ways.

The Internet and Society

Pew Research Center • 2005

Close Reading

"The internet has fundamentally changed how Americans communicate, work, and access information. Email has largely replaced letter writing for personal and business correspondence. Social networking sites allow people to maintain hundreds of relationships simultaneously."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

By 2005, the internet had moved from novelty to necessity for many Americans. Research organizations like the Pew Research Center began documenting how digital tools were reshaping the way people communicated, worked, and found information.

ANALYZE

According to this source, how has the internet changed American life?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	Pew Research Center	2005	Consider that a research organization aims to describe trends with evidence, not to sell a product.

Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Internet Revolution

Revolución de Internet

say: IN-ter-net rev-uh-LOO-shun

IR

The rapid late-20th-century spread of the internet, transforming how people communicate, work, and access information.

Personal Computer

Computadora Personal

say: PER-sun-ul kum-PYOO-ter

PC

An affordable home computer that became common in the 1980s-90s, changing work, school, and daily life.

Smartphone

Teléfono Inteligente

say: SMART-fohn

SM

A mobile phone with internet and computer features, widespread after 2007, that put communication in every pocket.

World Wide Web

Red Informática Mundial

say: world wyd WEB

WW

A system of linked web pages, opened to the public in the 1990s, that made the internet easy to use.

Social Media

Redes Sociales

say: SOH-shul MEE-dee-uh

SM

Online platforms of the 2000s that let people share content and connect instantly around the world.

Digital Divide

Brecha Digital

say: DIJ-ih-tul dih-VYD

DD

The gap between those who have reliable access to computers and the internet and those who do not.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Compare and contrast across time

MODEL PROMPT: How do I compare how a 1975 teenager and a teenager today would stay in touch with a friend?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

In 1975 they wrote letters and made rare phone calls; today they text and use social media instantly.

THINK ALOUD

To compare and contrast, I identify what is similar (both want to connect) and what is different (speed, cost, and how personal it feels).

→ **Now you try:** *Now you: name one advantage and one drawback of today's communication compared with the 1970s.*

The Digital Revolution — Then vs. Now Venn

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes, complete the Venn diagram comparing communication BEFORE and AFTER the digital revolution. In the outer circles, record what was distinct to each era (letters, landline phones, and printed newspapers before; the personal computer, the Internet, email, cell phones, and social media after). In the overlap, record what stayed the same (people's need to connect and share information). Finish with a claim about how faster communication changed everyday life and the economy.

DELIVERABLE

Completed Venn diagram (2+ items per section, including the shared overlap) plus a one-sentence claim on the single technology that changed communication the most.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Venn diagram with sentence stems and a word bank (personal computer, Internet, email, cell phone, social media) to place. Honors: Analyze how the digital revolution changed not just communication but also work, politics, and privacy. Defend with evidence.

Companion printable: <printables/unit-10/unit-10-venn.html>

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

What benefits and concerns does this source identify about modern communication?

- A** Only benefits — instant global connection with no drawbacks
- B** Only concerns — technology has made communication worse
- C** Global connection and instant communication, but also privacy concerns, misinformation, and less face-to-face interaction
- D** No significant changes from earlier communication methods

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What benefits and concerns does this source identify about modern communication?

- A** Only benefits — instant global connection with no drawbacks
- B** Only concerns — technology has made communication worse
- C** Global connection and instant communication, but also privacy concerns, misinformation, and less face-to-face interaction ✓
- D** No significant changes from earlier communication methods

Correct answer: C. Why: The testimony notes benefits like "instant communication across continents" but also "concerns about privacy, misinformation, and the decline of face-to-face interaction."

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- 1970s Communication Technologies
- Present-Day Communication Methods
- Comparing Characteristics and Limitations
- Societal Impact

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Analyze how the digital revolution changed not just communication but also work, politics, and privacy. Defend your answer with evidence.

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Compare how Americans communicated in the 1970s with how they communicate today. Name at least two changes and one effect on society.

STANDARD

US.95

Obama Administration Achievements and Setbacks

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the achievements and setbacks of President Barack Obama's administration.

I CAN

I can describe the achievements and setbacks of President Barack Obama's administration.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.94 We just studied the evolution of communication. How did communication change from the 1970s to today?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Who became the first African American president of the United States, in 2009?

✓ **ANSWER**

Barack Obama.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In 2009, Barack Obama took office as the first African American president — facing the worst economic crisis since the Great Depression, two wars, and a health-care system he set out to reform, all amid deep political division.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Obama entered office promising “hope” and “change” during a national crisis. When a leader inherits enormous problems, how should we measure success — by what they fixed, or by what they attempted?

Major Achievements

- Healthcare: The Affordable Care Act (Obamacare) expanded health insurance to millions of uninsured Americans.
- Economic Recovery: The American Recovery and Reinvestment Act helped end the Great Recession, with unemployment falling from 10% to 4.7%.
- Foreign Policy: the Paris Climate Agreement, the Iran nuclear deal, normalized relations with Cuba, and the killing of Osama bin Laden.
- Social Progress: marriage equality advancement and the DACA program for young immigrants.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The Obama administration achieved ___, but faced the setback of ___, because ____.

Significant Setbacks

- Legislative battles: Republican opposition limited Obama's agenda after 2010 midterm losses, leading to government shutdowns and debt ceiling crises.
- Foreign policy challenges: the Syrian civil war response, ISIS emergence, Russian aggression in Ukraine, and the Benghazi attack created difficult situations without clear solutions.

Partisan Conflicts

- Obama faced unprecedented Republican obstruction, including blocking his Supreme Court nomination of Merrick Garland for nearly a year.
- Racial tensions persisted despite — and sometimes because of — having the first Black president.
- His presidency demonstrated both the possibilities and limitations of presidential power in an increasingly polarized political environment.

Key Figure

President Barack Obama

44th President of the United States

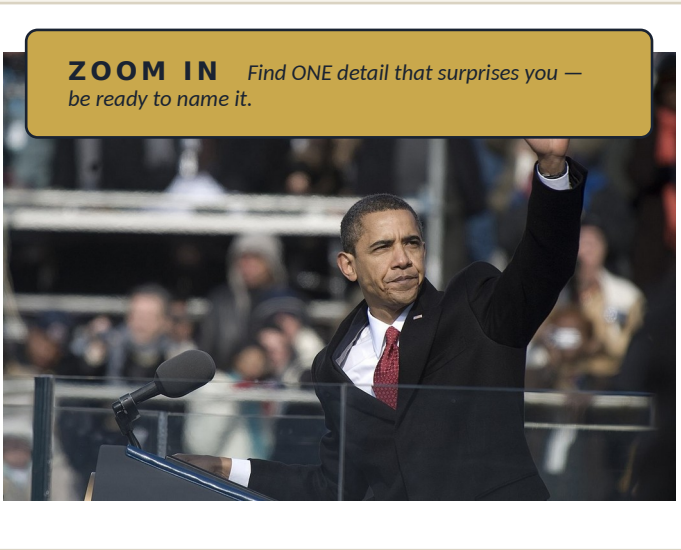
- First African American president of the United States (2009)
- Signed the Affordable Care Act (2010) and ordered the operation that killed Osama bin Laden (2011)

STRATEGY Coalition politics ("hope and change")

First Inaugural Address

Contextualization

President Barack Obama • January 20, 2009



U.S. Navy (photo 090120-N-0696M-327), January 20, 2009
[U.S. Department of Defense](#)

"That we are in the midst of crisis is now well understood. Our nation is at war, against a far-reaching network of violence and hatred. Our economy is badly weakened, a consequence of greed and irresponsibility on the part of some... Today I say to you that the challenges we face are real."

CONTEXT

Barack Obama took office in January 2009 as the first African American president, amid the worst economic crisis since the Great Depression and two ongoing wars. His inaugural address candidly named the crises the nation faced.

ANALYZE

What challenges does Obama acknowledge America faces?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	President Barack Obama	January 20, 2009	Consider that an inaugural address is meant to set the tone and priorities for a new presidency at a moment of national crisis.

Source: [National Archives](#)

Word Wall

Affordable Care Act

Ley de Cuidado de Salud Asequible

say: uh-FOR-duh-bul KAIR akt

AC

President Obama's 2010 health-care law ('Obamacare') expanding insurance coverage to millions of Americans.

Great Recession

Gran Recesión

say: grayt ree-SESH-un

GR

The severe 2007-09 economic downturn — the worst since the Great Depression — marked by a housing and banking crisis.

American Recovery and Reinvestment Act

Ley de Recuperación y Reinversión

say: uh-MER-ih-kun ree-KUV-er-ee

AR

A 2009 stimulus law that used federal spending and tax cuts to fight the Great Recession.

First African American President

Primer Presidente Afroamericano

say: furst AF-rih-kun uh-MER-ih-kun

FA

Barack Obama, elected in 2008, whose presidency was a historic milestone in U.S. history.

Death of Osama bin Laden

Muerte de Osama bin Laden

say: deth of oh-SAH-muh bin LAH-den

DO

The 2011 U.S. special-forces raid that killed the al-Qaeda leader behind the 9/11 attacks.

Partisan Gridlock

Estancamiento Partidista

say: PAR-tih-zun GRID-lok

PG

Sharp division between Democrats and Republicans that blocked lawmaking during much of Obama's presidency.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Balance achievements against setbacks

MODEL PROMPT: Obama passed the ACA but faced heavy opposition. How do I describe both his achievements and setbacks?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

He expanded healthcare and led an economic recovery, but faced gridlock and foreign-policy challenges.

THINK ALOUD

To balance a record, I list achievements and setbacks side by side and judge each on its lasting impact, rather than deciding he only succeeded or only failed.

→ **Now you try:** Now you: name one Obama achievement and one setback, and explain why both belong in a fair description of his presidency.

The Obama Years — Achievements & Setbacks Chart

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes and Obama's inaugural address excerpt, complete the Cause & Effect organizer for the Obama presidency. In CAUSES, list the challenges he inherited (the 2008 Great Recession, wars abroad, a divided health-care system). In EFFECTS, trace the responses — the economic stimulus and auto rescue, the Affordable Care Act, the killing of Osama bin Laden, and being the first African American president — along with the setbacks of political gridlock and a slow recovery. Finish with a claim about Obama's most significant achievement.

DELIVERABLE

Completed Cause & Effect organizer (3+ causes, 3+ effects, labeled achievement or setback) plus a one-sentence claim on Obama's most lasting legacy.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer with a word bank (Great Recession, stimulus, Affordable Care Act, bin Laden, first Black president) to sort into achievements vs. setbacks. Honors: Evaluate whether Obama should be judged more by his response to the Great Recession or by the Affordable Care Act. Argue with evidence.

Companion printable: [printables/unit-10/unit-10-cause-effect.html](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/printables/unit-10/unit-10-cause-effect.html)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

How does Obama describe the significance of the Affordable Care Act?

- A** As a minor adjustment to existing healthcare laws
- B** As a temporary measure until a better solution was found
- C** As a compromise that satisfied no one
- D** As a historic achievement ensuring basic health security for all Americans

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How does Obama describe the significance of the Affordable Care Act?

- A** As a minor adjustment to existing healthcare laws
- B** As a temporary measure until a better solution was found
- C** As a compromise that satisfied no one
- D** As a historic achievement ensuring basic health security for all Americans ✓

Correct answer: D. Why: Obama describes it as coming "after almost a century of trying" and establishing "the core principle that everybody should have some basic security when it comes to their health care."

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Major Achievements
- Significant Setbacks
- Partisan Conflicts

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate whether Obama should be judged more by his response to the Great Recession or by the Affordable Care Act. Argue with evidence.

EXIT TICKET

DOK 3

Describe two achievements and one setback of the Obama administration. Why is his presidency historically significant?

Unit 10 Complete

The Modern Era (1964–2016) · from the Great Society and 1960s activism, through Watergate and the end of the Cold War, to 9/11, the digital revolution, and the Obama years.

Revisit your unit hook: How did the United States move from the confidence of the Great Society in 1964 to the challenges and transformations of the twenty-first century? You can now answer with evidence — from Medicare and the War on Poverty, through Vietnam-era protest and Watergate, Reagan and the fall of the Berlin Wall, 9/11 and the digital revolution, to the election of the first African American president.

U.S. History Hack · The complete TCAP EOC course, Units 1-10